

SENATE No. 2399

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Robyn K. Kennedy

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to provide identification to youth and adults experiencing homelessness.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Robyn K. Kennedy</i>	<i>First Worcester</i>	
<i>John F. Keenan</i>	<i>Norfolk and Plymouth</i>	<i>1/29/2025</i>
<i>Joan B. Lovely</i>	<i>Second Essex</i>	<i>2/19/2025</i>
<i>Patrick M. O'Connor</i>	<i>First Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>3/27/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>4/2/2025</i>
<i>Sal N. DiDomenico</i>	<i>Middlesex and Suffolk</i>	<i>4/11/2025</i>
<i>Mark C. Montigny</i>	<i>Second Bristol and Plymouth</i>	<i>4/28/2025</i>
<i>Joanne M. Comerford</i>	<i>Hampshire, Franklin and Worcester</i>	<i>6/10/2025</i>
<i>John C. Velis</i>	<i>Hampden and Hampshire</i>	<i>6/10/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>6/11/2025</i>
<i>Adam Gómez</i>	<i>Hampden</i>	<i>6/17/2025</i>
<i>Michael O. Moore</i>	<i>Second Worcester</i>	<i>6/30/2025</i>

SENATE No. 2399

By Ms. Kennedy, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 2399) of Robyn K. Kennedy, John F. Keenan and Joan B. Lovely for legislation to provide identification to youth and adults experiencing homelessness. Transportation.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 2251 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to provide identification to youth and adults experiencing homelessness.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Section 8E of Chapter 90 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition,
2 is hereby amended by adding the following 2 paragraphs:-

3 The regulations establishing criteria for identification cards shall include a process for a
4 person who is homeless or is an unaccompanied homeless youth to apply for a Massachusetts
5 identification card and to waive any fees associated with obtaining the identification card;
6 provided, however, that the process shall allow for a person who is homeless or is an
7 unaccompanied homeless youth to submit proof of residency by providing documentation that is
8 satisfactory to the registrar and that is: (i) from an entity that provides housing services or youth
9 services in the commonwealth, including, but not limited to, homeless service providers; or (ii)
10 evidence of services that the person received from a department, division, office or agency of the

11 executive office of health and human services or executive office of housing and livable
12 communities. The registrar and the state secretary shall enter into a memorandum of
13 understanding under section 42G ½ of chapter 51 to implement this paragraph, as appropriate.

14 For the purposes of this section, the following terms shall have the following meanings:

15 “Homeless”, shall have the same meaning as in section 103 of the Stewart B. McKinney
16 Homeless Assistance Act of 1987, 42 USC 11302(a), as amended.

17 “Unaccompanied homeless youth”, a person who: (i) is 24 years of age or younger; (ii) is
18 not in the physical custody or care of a parent or legal guardian; and (iii) lacks a fixed, regular
19 and adequate nighttime residence.